Version 1.0 | 2026-10-22 | Current

Planning Notes: Selection and Project Management

Part A: How I chose what goes in this portfolio

The most important criterion for choosing portfolio work is distinguishing between two skills that often get combined: the ability to execute correctly within a structure someone else built, and the ability to build or choose the structure myself. These are different competencies, even though the finished product can look identical on the page. A perfectly formatted accession record or policy produced from a template the instructor provided, applying a standard the instructor named, or describing a collection that was already laid out, demonstrates that I can follow instructions well. It isn't evidence of independent archival judgement. I essentially 'inherited' a decision-making exercise and executed it. What counts as stronger evidence is any piece of work where those calls were mine to make and defend.

My selection rules

1. Each of the nine competency components gets one main artifact. If I have both coursework and hands-on work for a component, I show and label both.
2. Every artifact has to be viewable inside the portfolio itself.
3. I prefer real work for the Savannah Municipal Archives over coursework when I have both.
4. I include only material I have permission to share. *See Ethics and Permissions.*

What I left out, and why

1. Museum Presentation: too large for GitHub. Replaced by the Strategic Plan coursework. Can be sent upon request.
2. Hands-on physical preservation work from my preservation course:
3. My coursework in ArchivesSpace: shows that I can input provided data; does not prove that I can determine description and arrangement when processing a collection.
4. Series of twelve blog posts for the Savannah Municipal Archives focused on the Civil Rights Movement in Savannah: not all posts are published yet. To visit the Archives' blog, click here: https://www.savannahga.gov/Blog.aspx?CID=12

What my selection makes invisible

The portfolio shows description and digitization much more than physical preservation; it shows no live reference work with patrons; the born-digital example is a transfer record, not a worked case; hands-on handling of paper and bound materials; the voices of the people in the collections come through only in finding-aid notes.

Part B: How I managed building this portfolio

Timeline (from the Build Log)

Date	What happened
2026-10-01	Version naming applied to all files. Museum Presentation replaced because of the file-size limit.
2026-10-12	Fingerprint (checksum) list created. First round of PastPerfect link checks.
2026-10-14	Lesson plans added to Outreach and Advocacy.
2026-10-22	Rubric self-score completed. Gaps found. This plan written.

Risks I identified and what I did

Risk	What happened or could happen	My response
File too large for GitHub	Happened 2026-10-01	Replaced the file; rule 2 above
PastPerfect items are outside my control	Links could break or items could be removed	Link checks on a schedule; contact the Archives if one fails
Fingerprint list falls out of date when files are renamed	Happened: the list still named old file names on 2026-10-22	Rebuilt on 2026-10-24; rebuild any time files change
Losing GitHub or my account	Portfolio would disappear	Second copy kept at on external hard drive; last updated 2026-10-22
Permission withdrawn for an item	Item has to come down	Remove it, note it in the Build Log

How this connects to running an archives program

A small archive with one or two staff would use the same habits, which are deciding what items to include in the Archives, estimating time, writing down risks, checking on a schedule, and keeping a log of decisions.